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Detection device

Abstract

According to an aspect, a detection device, includes a flexible substrate, a plurality of light sensors provided in a detection region of the flexible substrate, a terminal that is provided at one end of the flexible substrate and is capable of being coupled to an external device, and a peripheral circuit that is provided on the flexible substrate and located between the detection region and the terminal.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION

(1) This application claims the benefit of priority from Japanese Patent Application No. 2021-115990 filed on Jul. 13, 2021, the entire contents of which are incorporated herein by reference.

BACKGROUND

1. Technical Field

(2) What is disclosed herein relates to a detection device.

2. Description of the Related Art

(3) Detection devices are known that utilize a plurality of light sensors (optical sensors) to obtain two-dimensional light-dark patterns (e.g., Japanese Patent Application Laid-open Publication No. 2016-164787 (JP-A-2016-164787)).

(4) The detection device described in JP-A-2016-164787 includes a received light signal readout circuit (optical signal readout circuit) that is coupled to a plurality of signal lines transmitting outputs from a plurality of light sensors, and a light receiving sensor operation circuit (optical sensor operation circuit) that operates switching elements interposed between the light sensors and the signal lines. The received light signal readout circuit is provided along one side of a rectangular-shaped detection region in which the light sensors are arranged. This structure has a high possibility of the received light signal readout circuit being damaged when the detection region is deformed in such a way that the detection region is curved or bent around a direction intersecting the one side and serving as the curvature or bending axis. The light receiving sensor operation circuit is provided along the other side of the rectangular-shaped detection region that is orthogonal to the one side along which the received light signal readout circuit is provided. This structure has a possibility of the light receiving sensor operation circuit being damaged when the detection region is deformed in such a way that the detection region is curved or bent around a direction intersecting the other side and serving as the curvature or bending axis. As described above, it is difficult for the detection device described in JP-A-2016-164787 to allow the detection region to be deformable.

(5) For the foregoing reasons, there is a need for a detection device that allows the detection region to be more deformable.

SUMMARY

(6) According to an aspect, a detection device, includes a flexible substrate, a plurality of light sensors provided in a detection region of the flexible substrate, a terminal that is provided at one end of the flexible substrate and is capable of being coupled to an external device, and a peripheral circuit that is provided on the flexible substrate and located between the detection region and the terminal.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram illustrating a main structure of a detection device;

(2) FIG. 2 is a circuit diagram illustrating a relation between a photodiode, a selection circuit, and a reset circuit;

(3) FIG. 3 is a schematic diagram illustrating a relation between coordinates of a plurality of partial detection regions included in a detection region, signal lines, scanning lines, and coupling lines;

(4) FIG. 4 is a schematic diagram illustrating a layered structure formed on one surface side of a flexible substrate;

(5) FIG. 5A is a plan view illustrating a positional relation between the signal line, the scanning line, and the coupling line near a switching element in an enlarged view region illustrated in FIG. 3;

(6) FIG. 5B is a further enlarged view of a configuration having an X coordinate of (p) and a Y coordinate of (p), which is the same coordinate value as the X coordinate, in 3×3 configurations illustrated in FIG. 5A;

(7) FIG. 6 is a cross-sectional view taken along line A-A' in FIG. 5A; and

(8) FIG. 7 is a schematic diagram illustrating a main structure of a conventional detection device.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(9) The following describes each embodiment of the present disclosure with reference to the accompanying drawings. The present disclosure is only an example, and any modification that can be easily conceived by a person skilled in the art while maintaining the main purpose of the invention is naturally included in the scope of the present disclosure. The width, thickness, shape, etc. of each part may be illustrated schematically in the drawings compared to the actual ones for the sake of clarity of explanation. Schematic illustrations are only examples and do not limit the interpretation of the present disclosure. In the present specification and in each figure, the same elements described in previous illustrated figures may be marked with the same symbols and detailed explanations may be omitted as appropriate.

(10) In this disclosure, when an element is described as being “on” another element, the element can be directly on the other element, or there can be one or more elements between the element and the other element.

(11) FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram illustrating a main structure of a detection device **1**. The detection device **1** includes a flexible substrate **21**, a plurality of photodiodes PD (refer to FIG. 2) provided in a detection region AA, a drive circuit **800**, a selection circuit **810**, a reset circuit **820**, and a terminal region **830**.

(12) The flexible substrate **21** has flexibility. Specifically, the flexible substrate **21** is a flexible printed circuit (FPC), for example. The drive circuit **800** is what is called a gate driver. The drive circuit **800** includes a built-in shift register that sequentially shifts a target to which a signal is applied.

(13) FIG. 2 is a circuit diagram illustrating a relation between the photodiode PD, the selection circuit **810**, and the reset circuit **820**. An individual electrode **321** side of the photodiode PD functions as a cathode. A common electrode **322** side of the photodiode PD functions as an anode. The individual electrode **321** side may function as the anode while the common electrode **322** side may function as the cathode. In that case, a relation between a function (as an electron transport layer or a hole blocking layer) of a first buffer layer **37** described later and a function (as a hole transport layer or an electron blocking layer) of a second buffer layer **38** described later is also reversed. The photodiode PD is coupled to one of a source and a drain of a switching element Tr via an individual electrode **321**. The photodiode PD is coupled in parallel to a capacitive element Ca, between the common electrode **322** and the one of the source and the drain of the switching element Tr.

(14) The other of the source and the drain of the switching element Tr is coupled to a corresponding one of a plurality of signal lines SGL(n), SGL(n+1), and so on. Hereinafter, the signal line SGL denotes any of the signal lines SGL(n), SGL(n+1), and so on, unless otherwise noted. A gate of the switching element Tr is coupled to a corresponding one of a plurality of scanning lines GCL(m), GCL(m+1), and so on. Hereinafter, the scanning line GCL denotes any of the scanning lines GCL(m), GCL(m+1), and so on, unless otherwise noted. Note that m and n are natural numbers.

(15) The electric power generated by the photodiode PD receiving light is stored in the capacitive element Ca coupled in parallel with the photodiode PD. When a drive signal is applied to the gate of the switching element Tr, the capacitive element Ca and the signal line SGL are coupled via the switching element Tr. The electric power that corresponds to the result of light detection performed by the photodiode PD until the drive signal is applied to the gate of the switching element Tr, is stored in the capacitive element Ca. When the drive signal is applied to the gate of the switching element Tr, a signal generated according to the electric power stored in the capacitive element Ca is therefore output via the switching element Tr and the signal line SGL. In this way, the photodiode PD functions as a light sensor (an optical sensor).

(16) The selection circuit **810** can switch targets that are to be coupled to a detection circuit **48**. Specifically, the selection circuit **810** has a plurality of switches TrS. One of the source and the drain of each of the switches TrS is coupled to a corresponding one of the signal lines SGL. The other of the source and the drain of each of the switches TrS is coupled to the detection circuit **48**.

Gates of the switches TrS are given an operation signal ASW at different timings. This allows the signal lines SGL to be coupled to the detection circuit **48** at different timings.

(17) The detection circuit **48** is an analog front end (AFE) circuit, for example. The detection circuit **48** is a signal processing circuit that has at least the functions of a detection signal amplifier **42** and an analog-to-digital (A/D) converter **43**. The detection signal amplifier **42** amplifies a detection signal Vdet. The A/D converter **43** converts an analog signal output from the detection signal amplifier **42** into a digital signal.

(18) The detection circuit **48** is coupled to the signal line SGL when a switch SSW is turned on. The detection signal amplifier **42** of the detection circuit **48** converts a variation of a current supplied from the signal line SGL into a variation of a voltage and amplifies the voltage variation. A reference voltage Vref having a fixed potential is input into a non-inverting input terminal (+) of the detection signal amplifier **42** while the signal line SGL is coupled to an inverting input terminal (−) of the detection signal amplifier **42**. In the embodiment, a signal having the same potential as that of a reset potential line COM, which is described later, is input as the reference voltage Vref. The detection signal amplifier **42** has a capacitive element Cb and a reset switch RSW. The charge of the capacitive element Cb in the detection circuit **48** is reset when the reset switch RSW is turned on. The operation of the detection circuit **48** is controlled by a host, which is described later.

(19) As illustrated in FIGS. 2 and 3, the extending direction of the scanning lines GCL intersects that of the signal lines SGL. Each of the scan lines GCL is shared by the switching elements Tr aligned along the extending direction of the scan line GCL. Each of the signal lines SGL is shared by the switching elements Tr aligned along the extending direction of the signal line SGL. The switching elements Tr are arranged two-dimensionally along the extending directions of the scanning lines GCL and the signal lines SGL. The individual electrodes **321**, the photodiodes PD, and the capacitive elements Ca, which are coupled to the switching elements Tr, are also two-dimensionally arranged in the same manner as the switching elements Tr. Hereinafter, the region including one of the switching elements Tr, the individual electrode **321**, the photodiode PD, and the capacitive element Ca that are coupled to the one of the switching elements Tr is referred to as a partial detection region PAA. The output from the partial detection region PAA denotes the output from the capacitive element Ca included in the partial detection region PAA.

(20) The switching elements Tr that share one of the scanning lines GCL do not share one of the signal lines SGL, but are respectively coupled to the different signal lines SGL. The switching elements Tr that share one of the signal lines SGL do not share one of the scanning lines GCL, but are respectively coupled to the different scanning lines GCL. As a result, the outputs from the different partial detection regions PAA are obtained through the signal lines SGL by applying the drive signal to the scanning lines GCL at different timings. The selection circuit **810** operates to switch the signal lines SGL to be coupled to the detection circuit **48**. As a result, the outputs from the different partial detection regions PAA are sequentially supplied to the detection circuit **48**.

(21) The reset circuit **820** resets the potential of each of the signal lines SGL. Specifically, the reset circuit **820** has a plurality of switches TrR. One of the source and the drain of each of the switches TrR is coupled to a corresponding one of the signal lines SGL. In other words, the signal lines SGL are respectively coupled to the sources or the drains of the switches TrR. The other of the source and the drain of each of the switches TrR is coupled to the reset potential line COM. The reset potential line COM is given a reset potential. The reset potential resets the signal lines SGL after the outputs from the partial detection regions PAA is transmitted. The reset potential is ground potential, for example. The reset potential is not limited to the ground potential and may be any other potential predetermined according to the design of the detection device **1**.

(22) After the signal lines SGL are each coupled to the detection circuit **48** once by the selection circuit **810**, the reset circuit **820** operates. Specifically, an operation signal RST2 is applied to the gates of the switches TrR of the reset circuit **820**. This causes the signal lines SGL and the reset potential line COM to be coupled, thereby resetting the potentials of the signal lines SGL and the

potentials of the capacitive elements Ca in the partial detection regions PAA including the switching elements coupled to the scanning line GCL to which the drive signal is applied.

(23) The terminal region **830** allows the detection device **1** to be coupled to an external device (host). As illustrated in FIG. **1**, terminals **831** are provided in the terminal region **830**. In FIG. **1**, more than one terminal is provided in the terminal region **830**. The number of terminals **831** provided in the terminal region **830**, however, may be one or more. In the embodiment of the present disclosure, the detection circuit **48** is provided in the host. The terminal region **830** is interposed between the selection circuit **810** and the detection circuit **48**. At least one of the terminals **831** in the terminal region **830** is coupled to a wiring line **811** extending from the selection circuit **810**. The specific standards for the shape and the like of the terminal region **830** correspond to the specific standards for a wiring line **481** extending from a switch SSW of the detection circuit **48**.

(24) The terminal region **830** may also include the terminals **831** of signal input lines coupled to the drive circuit **800**, the selection circuit **810**, and the reset circuit **820**. Various signals such as the operation signal ASW and the operation signal RST2 are applied from the host via the signal input lines. When there is input and output of signals necessary for operation control of the detection device **1**, the wiring lines for such input and output are also coupled to the terminals **831** in the terminal region **830** besides the signal input lines described above.

(25) As illustrated in FIG. **1**, the terminal region **830** is a part of the flexible substrate **21** and is provided at one end of a peripheral region SA that surrounds the detection region AA. The drive circuit **800**, the selection circuit **810**, and the reset circuit **820** are arranged between the detection region AA and the terminal region **830**. As described above, the flexible substrate **21** has flexibility. In the flexible substrate **21**, a part on the detection region AA side of the drive circuit **800** thus can be deformed, such as curved, to the extent that a non-deformation region ND provided with the drive circuit **800**, the selection circuit **810**, the reset circuit **820**, and the terminal region **830** is not deformed. For example, a part of the flexible substrate **21** including the detection region AA can be deformed such that the detection region AA is rounded in a cylindrical shape around a deformation axis SH illustrated in FIG. **1**.

(26) The drive circuit **800** applies the drive signal to the scanning line GCL. The drive circuit **800** is coupled to the scanning line GCL via a coupling line GCC (refer to FIG. **3**). The following describes the coupling between the drive circuit **800** and the scanning lines GCL via the coupling lines GCC with reference to FIG. **3**.

(27) FIG. **3** is a schematic diagram illustrating a relation between the coordinates of the partial detection regions PAA included in the detection region AA, the signal lines SGL, the scanning lines GCL, and the coupling lines GCC. In the explanation with reference to FIG. **3**, 8×8 partial detection regions PAA arranged in a matrix having a row-column configuration are used as an example. The number and arrangement of partial detection regions PAA are not limited to those of the example and can be changed as appropriate. In the explanation with reference to FIG. **3**, $X(1), X(2), \dots, X(8)$ are added as the X coordinates along one of the alignment directions of the partial detection regions PAA. The X direction corresponds to the direction along the one of the alignment directions of the partial detection regions PAA. In the explanation with reference to FIG. **3**, $Y(1), Y(2), \dots, Y(8)$ are added as the Y coordinates along the other of the alignment directions of the partial detection regions PAA. The Y direction corresponds to the direction along the other of the alignment directions of the partial detection regions PAA. The Z direction is orthogonal to the X and Y directions.

(28) When the position of a configuration (partial detection region PAA) is described in combination with the X and Y coordinates, it is represented as $(X, Y)=(p, q)$. p and q are any natural numbers in a range from 1 to 8. When the number of partial detection regions PAA aligned in the X direction is natural number P that is not 8, p is any natural number in a range from 1 to P. When the number of partial detection regions PAA aligned in the Y direction is natural number Q

that is not 8, then q is any natural number in a range from 1 to Q . For example, a configuration at $(X, Y)=(1, 1)$ denotes a configuration at the position having the coordinates $X(1)$ and $Y(1)$.

(29) As illustrated in FIG. 3, the signal line SGL is provided at each of the X coordinates.

Specifically, the signal line SGL(p) is provided at the X coordinate of $X(p)$ and extends in the Y direction. For example, the signal line SGL(1) is provided at the X coordinate of $X(1)$. The partial detection regions PAA that have the same X coordinate and are aligned in the Y direction share the signal line SGL provided at the X coordinate. In other words, the switching elements Tr (refer to FIG. 2) included in the partial detection regions PAA having the X coordinate of $X(p)$ share the signal line SGL(p).

(30) As illustrated in FIG. 3, the scanning line GCL is provided at each of the Y coordinates.

Specifically, the scanning line GCL(q) is provided at the Y coordinate of $Y(q)$ and extends in the X direction. For example, the scanning line GCL(1) is provided at the Y coordinate of $Y(1)$. The partial detection regions PAA that have the same Y coordinate and are aligned in the X direction share the scanning line GCL provided at the Y coordinate. In other words, the switching elements Tr (refer to FIG. 2) included in the partial detection regions PAA having the Y coordinate of $Y(q)$ share the scanning line GCL(q).

(31) As illustrated in FIG. 3, the drive circuit 800 is coupled to the scanning line GCL(q) via the coupling line GCC(q). The scanning line GCL(q) and the coupling line GCC(q) are coupled via a contact CP(q). For example, the scanning line GCL(1) and the coupling line GCC(1) are coupled via the contact CP(1). The scanning line GCL(1) and the drive circuit 800 are coupled via the coupling line GCC(1).

(32) The coupling line GCC extends in the Y direction. In the example illustrated in FIG. 3, the number of partial detection regions PAA aligned in the X direction is equal to the number of partial detection regions PAA aligned in the Y direction. The coupling line GCC is thus provided at each of the X coordinates. In the example illustrated in FIG. 3, the coupling lines GCC(1), GCC(2), . . . , GCC(8) are exemplarily illustrated. As used herein, the coupling line GCC denotes any one of the coupling lines GCC(1), . . . , GCC(q).

(33) The contact CP(q) illustrated in FIG. 3 couples the scanning line GCL(q) and the coupling line GCC(q) within the partial detection region PAA at $(X, Y)=(q, q)$. Specifically, the contact CP(q) illustrated in FIG. 3 is provided at a position that overlaps with the individual electrode 321 included in the partial detection region PAA at $(X, Y)=(q, q)$ in a plan view. The plan view is a view of the detection region AA viewed from the front. For example, the contact CP(1) is provided at a position that overlaps with the individual electrode 321 included in the partial detection region PAA at $(X, Y)=(1, 1)$ in a plan view.

(34) The following describes a layered structure forming the photodiode PD and the switching element Tr that are provided in the partial detection region PAA with reference to FIG. 4.

(35) FIG. 4 is a schematic diagram illustrating the layered structure formed on one surface side of the flexible substrate 21. An undercoat layer 221, a light-blocking metal 222, an undercoat layer 223, a semiconductor 224, a gate insulating film 225, a gate metal 226, an insulating film 227, a metal layer, a planarization film 23, a barrier layer 231, the individual electrode 321, the first buffer layer 37, a photoelectric conversion layer 31, the second buffer layer 38, the common electrode 322, and a sealing film 24 are layered in the Z direction on the one surface side of the flexible substrate 21 in this order from the flexible substrate 21.

(36) The undercoat layers 221 and 223, the gate insulating film 225, the insulating film 227, the planarization film 23, and the sealing film 24 have an insulating property. As a result, no electrical conduction is established between elements that are separated by one of the undercoat layers 221 and 223, the gate insulating film 225, the insulating film 227, the planarization film 23, and the sealing film 24.

(37) For a specific example of the films, the undercoat layers 221 and 223 are formed of an epoxy resin composition, for example, but may be inorganic films. The gate insulating film 225 and the

insulating film **227** are insulating layers formed of a nitride such as silicon nitride, for example. The planarization film **23** is an organic planarization film formed of one of acrylic, polyimide, and polyacrylamide, for example. The sealing film **24** is formed using a polymer such as Parylene (registered trademark), for example.

(38) The light-blocking metal **222** is located on the flexible substrate **21** side of the semiconductor **224** and has a light-blocking property. Most of light from the flexible substrate **21** side is blocked by the light-blocking metal **222** and hardly reaches the semiconductor **224**. The undercoat layer **223** is interposed between the light-blocking metal **222** and the semiconductor **224**.

(39) The semiconductor **224** is interposed between the source and the drain of the switching element Tr. The gate metal **226** functions as the gate of the semiconductor **224**. The gate insulating film **225** is interposed between the semiconductor **224** and the gate metal **226**.

(40) The metal layer includes SD metals **2281** and **2282**. The SD metal **2281** is the other of the source and the drain of the switching element Tr and is coupled to the signal line SGL. The SD metal **2282** is the one of the source and the drain of the switching element Tr and is coupled to the individual electrode **321**. The SD metal **2281** is formed to fill a contact hole CH1 formed in the gate insulating film **225** and the insulating film **227** and is coupled to the semiconductor **224**. The SD metal **2282** is formed to fill a contact hole CH2 formed in the gate insulating film **225** and the insulating film **227** and is coupled to the semiconductor **224**. The SD metals **2281** and **2282** are coupled via the semiconductor **224**. The gate metal **226** is located between the SD metals **2281** and **2282** and is insulated from the SD metals **2281** and **2282** by the gate insulating film **225** and the insulating film **227**.

(41) The specific compositions of the semiconductor **224**, the metal layer including the SD metals **2281** and **2282**, and the gate metal **226** correspond to the semiconductor and wiring materials employed in the switching device Tr that functions as a thin film transistor (TFT). The semiconductor **224** is hydrogenated amorphous silicon (a-Si:H), for example. The metal layer is aluminum (Al), for example. The gate metal **226** is polysilicon or aluminum (Al). The compositions are not limited to these examples.

(42) The individual electrode **321** is formed along the inner circumferential surface of a contact hole CH3 formed in the planarization film **23** and the barrier layer **231** that are layered on the SD metal **2282**. The individual electrode **321** and the SD metal **2282** are coupled on the bottom of the contact hole CH3. The individual electrode **321** is disposed between the barrier layer **231** and the photoelectric conversion layer **31** and extends along the barrier layer **231** from the contact hole CH3. As illustrated in FIG. 3, the individual electrode **321** is provided for each partial detection region PAA. In other words, each of the photodiodes PD has the individual electrode **321**.

(43) The photoelectric conversion layer **31** changes its characteristics (e.g., a voltage-current characteristic and a resistance value) depending on received light. Organic materials are used as the material for the photoelectric conversion layer **31**. Specifically, low molecular organic materials such as C.sub.60 (fullerene), PCBM (phenyl C.sub.61-butyl acid methyl ester), CuPc (copper phthalocyanine), F.sub.16CuPc (fluorinated copper phthalocyanine), rubrene (5,6,11,12-tetraphenyltetracene), and/or PDI (a derivative of perylene) can be used for the photoelectric conversion layer **31**.

(44) The photoelectric conversion layer **31** can be formed using these low molecular organic materials by vapor deposition (dry process). In this case, the photoelectric conversion layer **31** may be a layered film of CuPc and F.sub.16CuPc, or a layered film of rubrene and C.sub.60, for example. The photoelectric conversion layer **31** can also be formed by coating (wet process). In this case, the photoelectric conversion layer **31** is made of a combination material of the low molecular organic materials described above and polymer organic materials. Examples of the usable polymer organic materials include P3HT (poly (3-hexylthiophene)) and F8BT (F8-alt-benzothiadiazole). The photoelectric conversion layer **31** can be a film of a mixture of P3HT and PCBM, or a film of a mixture of F8BT and PDI.

(45) The first buffer layer **37** is formed to cover the individual electrode **321**. The second buffer layer **38** is formed between the photoelectric conversion layer **31** and the common electrode **322**. The first buffer layer **37** and the second buffer layer **38** are provided to facilitate the arrival of holes and electrons generated in the photoelectric conversion layer **31** at the common electrode **322** or the individual electrode **321**. The first buffer layer **37** functions as an electron transport layer (hole blocking layer). The second buffer layer **38** functions as a hole transport layer (electron blocking layer).

(46) Examples of usable material for the first buffer layer **37** include titanium oxide (TiO.sub.x). Examples of usable material for the second buffer layer **38** include tungsten oxide (WO.sub.3) and yttrium oxide (Y.sub.2O.sub.3). P3HT, which is one of the organic materials described above, is used for a p-type semiconductor layer **32**, for example. PCBM, which is one of the organic materials described above, is used for an n-type semiconductor layer **33**, for example.

(47) The common electrode **322** is formed to cover the photoelectric conversion layer **31**. The common electrode **322** covers the entire detection region AA in a plan view. In other words, the photodiodes PD share the common electrode **322**. The sealing film **24** is formed to cover the common electrode **322**. The sealing film **24** covers the entire detection region AA in a plan view.

(48) The individual electrode **321** and the common electrode **322** face each other with the photoelectric conversion layer **31** therebetween. The photoelectric conversion layer **31** between the individual electrode **321** and the common electrode **322** generates a photovoltaic effect. The individual electrode **321**, the common electrode **322**, and the photoelectric conversion layer **31** in each partial detection region PAA thus function as the photodiode PD. The individual electrode **321** is made of a metal material, for example. Examples of the metal material include silver (Ag) and aluminum (Al). The individual electrode **321** may be an alloy material containing at least one or more of these metal materials. The common electrode **322** is made of a conductive material having translucency such as indium tin oxide (ITO), for example.

(49) The following describes a positional relation between the signal line SGL, the scanning line GCL, and the coupling line GCC near the switching element Tr, which is provided between the individual electrode **321** and the flexible substrate **21** in a plan view, with reference to FIGS. 5A and 5B.

(50) FIG. 5A is a plan view illustrating the positional relation between the signal line SGL, the scanning line GCL, and the coupling line GCC near the switching element Tr in an enlarged viewing region CU illustrated in FIG. 3. FIG. 5B is a further enlarged view of the configuration having the X coordinate of (p) and the Y coordinate of (p), which is the same coordinate value as the X coordinate, in the 3×3 configurations illustrated in FIG. 5A. In FIG. 5B, the same dot pattern is added to the elements in the same layer as the gate metal **226**. The following describes the positioning relation between the signal line SGL, the scanning line GCL, and the coupling line GCC near the switching element Tr by exemplifying those elements in the partial detection region PAA at (X, Y)=(1, 1). The same positional relation as described below is applied to the partial detection regions PAA at the positions having the other X and Y coordinates.

(51) Separated portions of the scanning line GCL(**1**), each of which is illustrated by the dashed line in FIG. 5A, are coupled via the gate metal **226** on the flexible substrate **21** side of the individual electrode **321** in the partial detection region PAA at (X, Y)=(1, 1). More specifically, the metal layer formed as the scanning line GCL(**1**) is separated into the two portions in the X direction on the flexible substrate **21** side of the individual electrode **321**. The two separated portions of the scanning line GCL(**1**) are coupled to each other via the gate metal **226** within the region overlapping with the individual electrode **321** in a plan view. It is described in a generalized manner that the separated portions of the scanning line GCL(q) are coupled to each other via the gate metal **226** on the flexible substrate **21** side of the individual electrode **321** in the configuration at (X, Y)=(p, q).

(52) In the present disclosure, the metal layer in which the scanning line GCL(**1**) is formed is the

same as the metal layer in which the SD metal **2281** is formed.

(53) The signal line SGL(**1**), which is illustrated by the dashed line in FIG. 5A, is continuous via the SD metal **2281** and a detour **2280** on the flexible substrate **21** side of the individual electrode **321** in the configuration at (X, Y)=(1, 1). The detour **2280**, which is illustrated by the dashed line, bends to detour the gate metal **226** in a plan view. The detour **2280** in the configuration at (X, Y)=(1, 1) extends from the Y coordinate of Y(2) side and detours the gate metal **226** to be coupled to the SD metal **2281** on the flexible substrate **21** side of the individual electrode **321** in the configuration at (X, Y)=(1, 1). In this way, the signal line SGL(**1**) is continuous at a position that does not overlap with the gate metal **226** in a plan view by passing the SD metal **2281** and the detour **2280**. It is described in a generalized manner that the signal line SGL(p) is continuous via the SD metal **2281** and the detour **2280** on the flexible substrate **21** side of the individual electrode **321** in the configuration at (X, Y)=(p, q). The signal line SGL and the detour **2280** are formed in the same metal layer in which the SD metal **2281** is formed.

(54) The SD metal **2282** is located at the position facing the semiconductor **224** with the gate metal **226** therebetween in a plan view on the flexible substrate **21** side of the individual electrode **321**. As described with reference FIG. 4, the SD metal **2282** and the individual electrode **321** are coupled to each other.

(55) The coupling line GCC(**1**), which is illustrated by the solid line in FIG. 5A, overlaps with the signal line SGL(**1**) outside the individual electrode **321** in a plan view. The coupling line GCC(**1**) bends on a side opposite to the detour **2280** with the gate metal **226** therebetween to detour the gate metal **226** in the individual electrode **321** in a plan view. As a result, the coupling line GCC is not contact with the gate metal **226**. It is described in a generalized manner that the coupling line GCC(q) overlaps with the signal line SGL(q) outside the individual electrode **321** in a plan view. The coupling line GCC(q) bends on the side opposite to the detour **2280** with the gate metal **226** therebetween to detour the gate metal **226** in the individual electrode **321** in a plan view.

(56) The coupling line GCC is formed in the same layer as the gate metal **226**. As a result, the coupling line GCC in the present disclosure is formed on the flexible substrate **21** side of the metal layer in which the signal line SGL is formed. The scanning line GCL and the gate metal **226** are insulated from each other with the insulating film **227**, and the coupling line GCC and the signal line SGL are insulated from each other with the insulating film **227**.

(57) FIG. 6 is a cross-sectional view taken along line A-A' in FIG. 5A. As illustrated in FIG. 6, the contact CP(q) is formed to be continuous with the scanning line GCL(q) so as to fill a contact hole CH4 formed in the insulating film **227** covering the gate metal **226**. More specifically, the contact holes CH4 are formed in the insulating film **227** at the positions of contacts CP(**1**), CP(**2**), and CP(**3**) that are illustrated in FIG. 5A. As an example, the position of the contact CP(**1**) illustrated in FIG. 5A is the position where the coupling line GCC(**1**) and the scanning line GCL(**1**) provided on the flexible substrate **21** side of the individual electrode **321** in the configuration at (X, Y)=(1, 1) intersect each other in a plan view. It is described in a generalized manner that the position of the contact CP(q) is the position where the coupling line GCC(q) and the scanning line GCL(q) provided on the flexible substrate **21** side of the individual electrode **321** in the configuration at (X, Y)=(q, q) intersect each other in a plan view. The scanning lines GCL(**1**), GCL(**2**), and GCL(**3**) and the contacts CP(**1**), CP(**2**), and CP(**3**) are formed by forming the scanning lines GCL(**1**), GCL(**2**), and GCL(**3**) such that these scanning lines overlap with the contact holes CH4. In the same manner as the contacts CP(**1**), CP(**2**), and CP(**3**), the contact CP(q) other than the contacts CP(**1**), CP(**2**), and CP(**3**) is also formed such that the coupling line GCC(q) and the scanning line GCL(q) are coupled at the position at which the coupling line GCC(q) and the scanning line GCL(q) intersect each other in a plan view on the flexible substrate **21** side of the individual electrode **321** in the configuration at (X, Y)=(q, q).

(58) As illustrated in FIG. 6, the scanning line GCL(q+1) (or scanning line GCL(q-1)) is adjacent to the scanning line GCL(q) that overlaps with the position at which the contact CP(q) is formed in

a plan view. The scanning line GCL(q+1) (or scanning line GCL(q-1)) is not coupled to the coupling line GCC(q+1) (or coupling line GCC(q-1)) at the x coordinate of X(q) at which the contact CP(q) is formed.

(59) FIG. 7 is a schematic diagram illustrating a main structure of a conventional detection device **1000**. The detection device **1000** includes a substrate **1021**, a detection region AA2, a drive circuit **1800**, a selection circuit **1810**, a reset circuit **1820**, and a terminal region **1830**. The substrate **1021** has the same structure as the flexible substrate **21**. In the detection region AA2, the photodiodes PD, which are the same as the photodiodes PD provided in the detection region AA, are arranged two-dimensionally. The gate of the switching element coupled to the photodiode PD provided in the detection region AA2 is coupled to the drive circuit **1800** via the scanning line GCL, not via the three-dimensional coupling between the coupling line GCC and the scanning line GCL, which is described above. The drive circuit **1800** has the same structure as the drive circuit **800**, except that the drive circuit **1800** is coupled directly to the scanning line GCL without the coupling line GCC and is provided at a position that is not between the detection region AA2 and the terminal region **1830**. The selection circuit **1810** has the same structure as the selection circuit **810**. The reset circuit **1820** has the same structure as the reset circuit **820**, except that the reset circuit **1820** is provided at a position opposite the selection circuit **1810** with the detection region AA2 therebetween. The terminal region **1830** has the same structure as the terminal region **830**.

(60) As illustrated in FIG. 7, the drive circuit **1800** is provided along one of the two orthogonal sides of the rectangular-shaped detection region AA2 while the selection circuit **1810**, the reset circuit **1820**, and the terminal region **1830** are provided along the other side. It is difficult for this structure to deform the detection region AA2 even though the substrate **1021** has flexibility. Assuming that the detection region AA2 is deformed, any of the circuits including the drive circuit **1800**, the selection circuit **1810**, and the reset circuit **1820**, and the interfaces including the terminal region **1830** may be damaged due to its mounting surface deformed in a curved shape as a result of the deformation of the detection region AA2. In contrast, the detection device **1** has more freedom of deformation within the range that does not affect the non-deforming region ND, as the example described above in which the detection device **1** is deformed in the cylindrical curvature around the deformation axis SH.

(61) As described above, the detection device **1** according to the present disclosure includes: a flexible substrate (the flexible substrate **21**); a plurality of light sensors (photodiodes PD) provided in a detection region (the detection region AA) of the flexible substrate; a terminal (the terminal **831**) that is provided at one end of the flexible substrate and is capable of being coupled to an external device; and a peripheral circuit (including the drive circuit **800** and the selection circuit **810**) that is provided on the flexible substrate and located between the detection region and the terminal.

(62) With this structure, deformation of the detection region (detection region AA) does not affect the peripheral circuit (including the drive circuit **800**, the selection circuit **810**) and the terminal (the terminal **831**) as long as the deformation interferes a region (e.g., the non-deforming region ND) between the detection region and the terminal. The present disclosure, thus, allows the detection region to be more deformable.

(63) The peripheral circuit includes a selection circuit (the selection circuit **810**) and a drive circuit (the drive circuit **800**). The selection circuit is a circuit of which the coupling relations with a plurality of signal lines (the signal lines SGL) are switchable, and is configured to establish a transmission path with one of the signal lines. The signal lines are configured to transmit outputs from the light sensors (the photodiodes PD). The drive circuit (the drive circuit **800**) applies a drive signal to gates of a plurality of switching elements (the switching elements Tr) interposed between the light sensors and the signal lines. This structure allows both making the detection region (the detection region AA) more easily deformable and providing the flexible substrate (the flexible substrate **21**) with the selection circuit and the drive circuit that are necessary for operation of the

light sensors.

(64) The peripheral circuit further includes a reset circuit (the reset circuit **820**) that is configured to reset the light sensors (photodiode PD). This structure allows both making the detection region (the detection region AA) more easily deformable and providing the reset circuit on the flexible substrate (the flexible substrate **21**).

(65) In the detection device **1**, the selection circuit (the selection circuit **810**), the drive circuit (the drive circuit **800**), and the reset circuit (the reset circuit **820**) are not provided at a position other than a position between the detection region (the detection region AA) and the terminal (the terminal **831**) in a peripheral region (the peripheral region SA) of the flexible substrate (the flexible substrate **21**). The peripheral region is located in a periphery of the detection region (detection region AA). This prevents a restriction on the deformation of the detection region that would occur when at least one of the selection circuit, the drive circuit, and the reset circuit is provided at a position other than the position between the detection region and the terminal. As a result, the detection region can be more deformable.

(66) The detection device **1** further includes: a plurality of scanning lines (the scanning lines GCL) that are coupled to the gates of the switching elements (the switching elements Tr); and a plurality of coupling lines (the coupling lines GCC) that couple the scanning lines individually to the drive circuit (the drive circuit **800**). The scanning line extends in one (the X direction) of alignment directions of the switching elements arranged in a matrix having a row-column configuration and is coupled to the gates of the switching elements aligned along the one of the alignment directions. The scanning lines are aligned in the other (the Y direction) of the alignment directions of the switching elements. The coupling line extends in the other of the alignment directions. The coupling lines are aligned in the one of the alignment directions. This makes it easier to place the drive circuit between the detection region (the detection region AA) and the terminal (terminal **831**).

(67) As illustrated in FIG. 3, one end of each of the coupling lines (the coupling lines GCC) is located farther from the drive circuit (the drive circuit **800**) than a scanning line (the scanning line GCL(**1**)) furthest from the drive circuit among the scanning lines (the scanning lines GCL). This makes it easier to align all of the scanning lines between the drive circuit and the one end of each coupling line. As a result, the coupling lines can establish the coupling relation between the drive circuit and the scanning lines more reliably.

(68) The signal lines (the signal lines SGL) and the coupling lines (the coupling lines GCC) overlap with each other while being insulated from each other within the detection region (the detection region AA). This makes it easier to complete the wiring of the signal line and the coupling line within the detection region. As a result, the peripheral region (the peripheral region SA) of the flexible substrate (the flexible substrate **21**) can be made narrower.

(69) The scanning lines (the scanning lines GCL) have intersections (the gate metals **226**) that intersect the signal lines (the signal lines SGL) while being insulated from the signal lines, and a portion other than the intersections is formed in the same layer as the signal lines in the layered structure formed on the flexible substrate (the flexible substrate **21**). This can further reduce the number of layers in the layered structure than the case where the portion of the scanning line excluding the intersection and the signal line are formed on different layers.

(70) The light sensor (the photodiode PD) includes: a photoelectric conversion layer (the photoelectric conversion layer **31**) that is configured to generate a photovoltaic effect; a buffer layer (the first buffer layer **37** or the second buffer layer **38**) that is configured to facilitate transfer of electrons or holes generated in response to electric power generated in the photoelectric conversion layer; and two electrodes (the individual electrode **321** and the common electrode **322**) that abut the photoelectric conversion layer via the buffer layer and face each other with the photoelectric conversion layer therebetween. One (the individual electrode **321**) of the two electrodes overlaps with the intersection (the gate metal **226**) while being isolated from the

intersection. With this configuration, the light sensor and the intersection (the gate metal **226**) of the scanning line (the scanning line GCL) with the signal line (the signal line SGL) can be arranged such that they overlap with each other three-dimensionally. This makes it easier to complete the wiring of the scanning lines and the signal lines within the detection region (the detection region AA). Consequentially, the peripheral region (the peripheral region SA) of the flexible substrate (the flexible substrate **21**) can be made narrower.

(71) The reset circuit **820** need not be formed on the flexible substrate **21**. For example, the reset circuit **820** may be provided in the host and coupled via the terminal **831** to the detection device **1** that includes no reset circuit **820**.

(72) In the above description, P and Q are both equal to 8, but P and Q need not be equal, or at least one of them can be any other natural number that is not 8. When P is greater than Q, some of the signal lines SGL do not overlap with the coupling line GCC. When P is less than Q, some of the coupling lines GCC do not overlap with the signal line SGL.

(73) It is also understood that any other effects that are obvious from the description of the specification or that can be conceived of by those skilled in the art are naturally brought about by the present disclosure.

Claims

1. A detection device, comprising: a flexible substrate; a plurality of light sensors provided in a detection region of the flexible substrate; a plurality of switching elements each having a source, a gate, and a drain; a terminal that is provided at one end of the flexible substrate and is capable of being coupled to an external device; a drive circuit; and a peripheral circuit that is provided on the flexible substrate and located between the detection region and the terminal, wherein one of the source and the drain of each of the switching elements is coupled to a corresponding one of the light sensors, the gate of each of the switching elements is coupled to corresponding one of a plurality of scanning lines each extending in a direction, the scanning lines being arranged in other direction, each of a plurality of coupling lines is coupled to a corresponding one of the scanning lines, the coupling lines each extending in the other direction, the coupling lines being arranged in the direction, other one of the source and the drain of each of the switching elements is coupled to a corresponding one of a plurality of signal lines each extending in the other direction, the signal lines being arranged in the direction, the coupling lines and the scanning lines are coupled to the peripheral circuit, and one end of each of the coupling lines is located farther from the drive circuit than a scanning line farthest from the drive circuit among the scanning lines.

2. The detection device according to claim 1, wherein the peripheral circuit includes: a selection circuit that is a circuit of which coupling relations with the signal lines are switchable and that is configured to establish a transmission path with one of the signal lines, the signal lines being configured to transmit outputs from the light sensors; and the drive circuit that is configured to apply a drive signal to gates of the switching elements interposed between the light sensors and the signal lines.

3. The detection device according to claim 2, wherein the peripheral circuit includes a reset circuit that is configured to reset the light sensors.

4. A detection device, comprising: a flexible substrate; a plurality of light sensors provided in a detection region of the flexible substrate; a terminal that is provided at one end of the flexible substrate and is capable of being coupled to an external device; and a peripheral circuit that is provided on the flexible substrate and located between the detection region and the terminal, wherein the peripheral circuit includes: a selection circuit that is a circuit of which coupling relations with a plurality of signal lines are switchable and that is configured to establish a transmission path with one of the signal lines, the signal lines being configured to transmit outputs from the light sensors; a drive circuit that is configured to apply a drive signal to gates of a plurality

of switching elements interposed between the light sensors and the signal lines; and a reset circuit that is configured to reset the light sensors, and the selection circuit, the drive circuit, and the reset circuit are not provided at a position other than a position between the detection region and the terminal in a peripheral region of the flexible substrate, the peripheral region being located in a periphery of the detection region.

5. A detection device, comprising: a flexible substrate; a plurality of light sensors provided in a detection region of the flexible substrate; a plurality of switching elements each having a source, a gate, and a drain; a terminal that is provided at one end of the flexible substrate and is capable of being coupled to an external device; a drive circuit; and a peripheral circuit that is provided on the flexible substrate and located between the detection region and the terminal, wherein one of the source and the drain of each of the switching elements is coupled to a corresponding one of the light sensors, the gate of each of the switching elements is coupled to corresponding one of a plurality of scanning lines each extending in a direction, the scanning lines being arranged in other direction, each of a plurality of coupling lines is coupled to a corresponding one of the scanning lines, the coupling lines each extending in the other direction, the coupling lines being arranged in the direction, other one of the source and the drain of each of the switching elements is coupled to a corresponding one of a plurality of signal lines each extending in the other direction, the signal lines being arranged in the direction, the coupling lines and the scanning lines are coupled to the peripheral circuit, and the signal lines and the coupling lines overlap with each other while being isolated from each other within the detection region.

6. The detection device according to claim 5, wherein the peripheral circuit includes: a selection circuit that is a circuit of which coupling relations with the signal lines are switchable and that is configured to establish a transmission path with one of the signal lines, the signal lines being configured to transmit outputs from the light sensors; and a drive circuit that is configured to apply a drive signal to gates of the switching elements interposed between the light sensors and the signal lines.

7. The detection device according to claim 6, wherein the peripheral circuit includes a reset circuit that is configured to reset the light sensors.

8. A detection device, comprising: a flexible substrate; a plurality of light sensors provided in a detection region of the flexible substrate; a plurality of switching elements each having a source, a gate, and a drain; a terminal that is provided at one end of the flexible substrate and is capable of being coupled to an external device; a drive circuit; and a peripheral circuit that is provided on the flexible substrate and located between the detection region and the terminal, wherein one of the source and the drain of each of the switching elements is coupled to a corresponding one of the light sensors, the gate of each of the switching elements is coupled to corresponding one of a plurality of scanning lines each extending in a direction, the scanning lines being arranged in other direction, each of a plurality of coupling lines is coupled to a corresponding one of the scanning lines, the coupling lines each extending in the other direction, the coupling lines being arranged in the direction, other one of the source and the drain of each of the switching elements is coupled to a corresponding one of a plurality of signal lines each extending in the other direction, the signal lines being arranged in the direction, the coupling lines and the scanning lines are coupled to the peripheral circuit, the scanning lines have intersections that intersect the signal lines while being insulated from the signal lines, and a portion other than the intersections is formed in the same layer as the signal lines in a layered structure formed on the flexible substrate.

9. The detection device according to claim 8, wherein each of the light sensors includes: a photoelectric conversion layer that is configured to generate a photovoltaic effect; a buffer layer that is configured to facilitate transfer of electrons or holes generated in response to electric power generated in the photoelectric conversion layer; and two electrodes that abut the photoelectric conversion layer via the buffer layer and face each other with the photoelectric conversion layer therebetween, and one of the two electrodes overlaps with a corresponding one of the intersections

while being isolated from the intersections.

10. The detection device according to claim 8, wherein the peripheral circuit includes: a selection circuit that is a circuit of which coupling relations with the signal lines are switchable and that is configured to establish a transmission path with one of the signal lines, the signal lines being configured to transmit outputs from the light sensors; and a drive circuit that is configured to apply a drive signal to gates of the switching elements interposed between the light sensors and the signal lines.

11. The detection device according to claim 10, wherein the peripheral circuit includes a reset circuit that is configured to reset the light sensors.
